UPFRONT

DURING THE COCKROACH JANTA PARTY PROTEST AT JANTAR MANTAR, DELHI POLICE DEPLOYED A LAYERED SURVEILLANCE NETWORK OF AI-POWERED FACIAL-RECOGNITION CAMERAS, DRONES, SMART GLASSES AND MOBILE COMMAND SYSTEMS TO MONITOR CROWDS IN REAL TIME. OFFICIALS DESCRIBED IT AS A LAW-AND-ORDER MEASURE; CRITICS ARGUED THAT THE SCALE OF BIOMETRIC TRACKING, VIDEO RECORDING AND DATA RETENTION RAISED CONCERNS ABOUT PRIVACY AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHTS TO ASSEMBLE AND EXPRESS FREELY

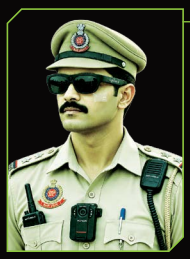


DP-DRISHTI

- Mobile facial-recognition vans with high-definition CCTV cameras

3 Vans deployed in high-footfall protest zones

- Scanned dense crowds in real time
- Flagged individuals with criminal records



WEARABLE TECHNOLOGY

AI-ENABLED SMART GLASSES

- Developed by Pune-based startup AjnaLens, first deployed during the 2026 Republic Day parade
- Integrated facial recognition, thermal imaging and live database linkage
- Instant alerts through earpiece or phone to senior officers wearing the glasses

BODY-WORN CAMERAS

- Compact, wearable devices that recorded audio, video and still images from the wearer's perspective
- Ensured independent video record of police interactions

OTHER MEASURES

- **SURVEILLANCE TOWERS:** Elevated watchtowers provided 24x7 camera coverage of the protest site
- **PRIVATE VIDEOGRAPHERS** Around 30 videographers were stationed on the ground for continuous photography